

FLOATING WALLS

BENGALURU, KARNATAKA

Plot Area: 3,430 sq ft

Built-up Area: 4,300 sq ft

Project Timeline: 2015 - 2019



CREST ARCHITECTS, BENGALURU

Principal Architect and Co-founder: Vikas MV, Vishwas Venkat

Project Team: Shreya R

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Living with elements of nature, this home in the urban backdrop of Marathalli, Bengaluru is crafted as a space of solace. The building aims to blend nature with the daily life of the users, not letting them feel disconnected from the spirit of nature amid the busy cityscape. Planning green spaces, courtyards, skylights and giving openings at relevant spaces, gives an interactive character to the house.

Nestled in the back drop of a metropolis, this residence promises an escape from the city life. The plot for this house sits in a densely populated locality. The major concern was finding an intimate space in the crowd and arriving at a visually engaging structure amidst the chaotic background.

The house is a display of intertwined indoor and outdoor spaces designed to filter in ample natural light and ventilation while ensuring a comfortable living environment. It adheres to the site conditions and has a strong element of individuality that enhances the quality of living through well stitched spaces, materials, techniques, craftsmanship and infuses the interiors with personalized detailing to create profound experiences. The slits and openings in the building have been designed to create an illusion of levitating masses, hence the name - Floating Walls.

The client's brief called for a simple and a spacious *vaastu* compliant house for a family of five. An introverted open plan layout has been adopted to create a seamless flow of spaces and to ensure connectivity across the floors. Designed around two landscaped courtyards, the building program is spread across three floors consisting of a parking area, formal and informal living, an open kitchen and dining, five bedrooms, a study and a semi-open terrace with a kitchenette. Both the courtyards have been strategically designed with skylights to bring in maximum light.

One is welcomed into the house by a 4" thick *Sadahalli* stone slab bridging over the Koi fish pond and a series of large granite steps. The traditional concept of load bearing and counter weight system has been used in the screen wall by cantilevering 2" thick *Sadahalli* slab, to create a dramatic impact at the entrance. Clear glass has been used in the formal and informal areas to establish a strong relationship with the outside. The central dining space is flanked by courts on both sides creating a tranquil ambience.

Inspired by origami – a Japanese art form, the captivating metal staircase in the southern court is cantilevered from a suspended wall unfolding a distinctive experience and a sense of lightness within the house. The northern court anchors the entire built space bringing in abundant natural light, providing a visual connection between the floors and setting a refreshing ambience.

Canopied by a temple tree, the artfully designed *pooja* sits as a distinguishing sculpture in this court. A transparent layer of glass introduced to bring in light to the rooms overlooking the courtyard has been furnished with fabric panels that provide flexibility of usage to the inhabitants. All these spaces within the house are wrapped around the courtyards, which symbolizes the 'exterior' within this introverted scheme. Skylights and multiple slits integrated in the design keep the interiors well lit, accentuates the spatial experience and makes certain a connection with nature that largely lacks in today's urban world.

The interiors are kept simple and have been devised with great attention to detail to blend smoothly with the architectural elements. Natural textures of wood and exposed concrete amidst the subtle elements and neutral colour palettes with accents like olive green, navy blue, crimson red and burnt orange create elegant spaces that exemplify a comprehensively designed urban home.

The exterior surfaces are a blend of clean white walls juxtaposed against timber and glass. A series of staggered slits have been deliberately positioned at unconventional heights throughout the building to allow light and maximum views of the outside without compromising on privacy. The striking inclined wall introduced at the front elevates the overall massing and adds a sense of dynamism to the building.



Play of cantilevers, slits and masses





Cantilevering stone creating a dramatic effect at the entrance





Cantilevered canopy over the main door





The lush tropical landscape around the house

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Living room filled with natural light





Informal living shares direct visual connection with greens





Double height court becomes the soul of the house





Artfully designed *pooja* sits as a sculpture in the court





Central dining space overlooking the court





View of the informal living from the dining





Central dining space with a teakwood feature wall





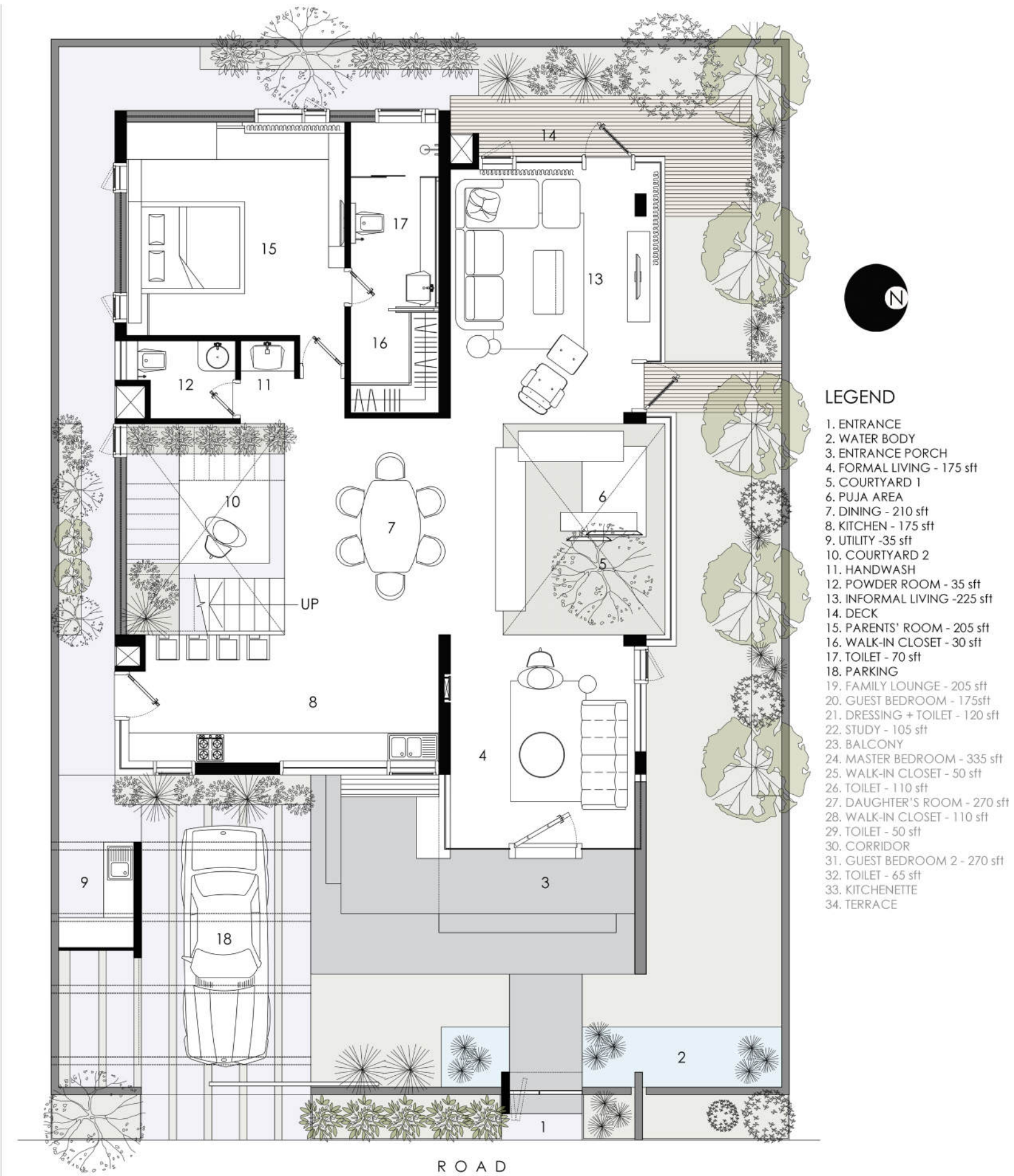
Open kitchen with suspended storage units





Origami inspired cantilevered metal staircase





Ground Floor Plan



The magnificent 10' long doors of the master and daughter's bedroom that camouflage into a wall





A cozy family lounge with skylight





View of lounge and ground floor living from the bedroom on first floor





Daughter's bedroom with mezzanine





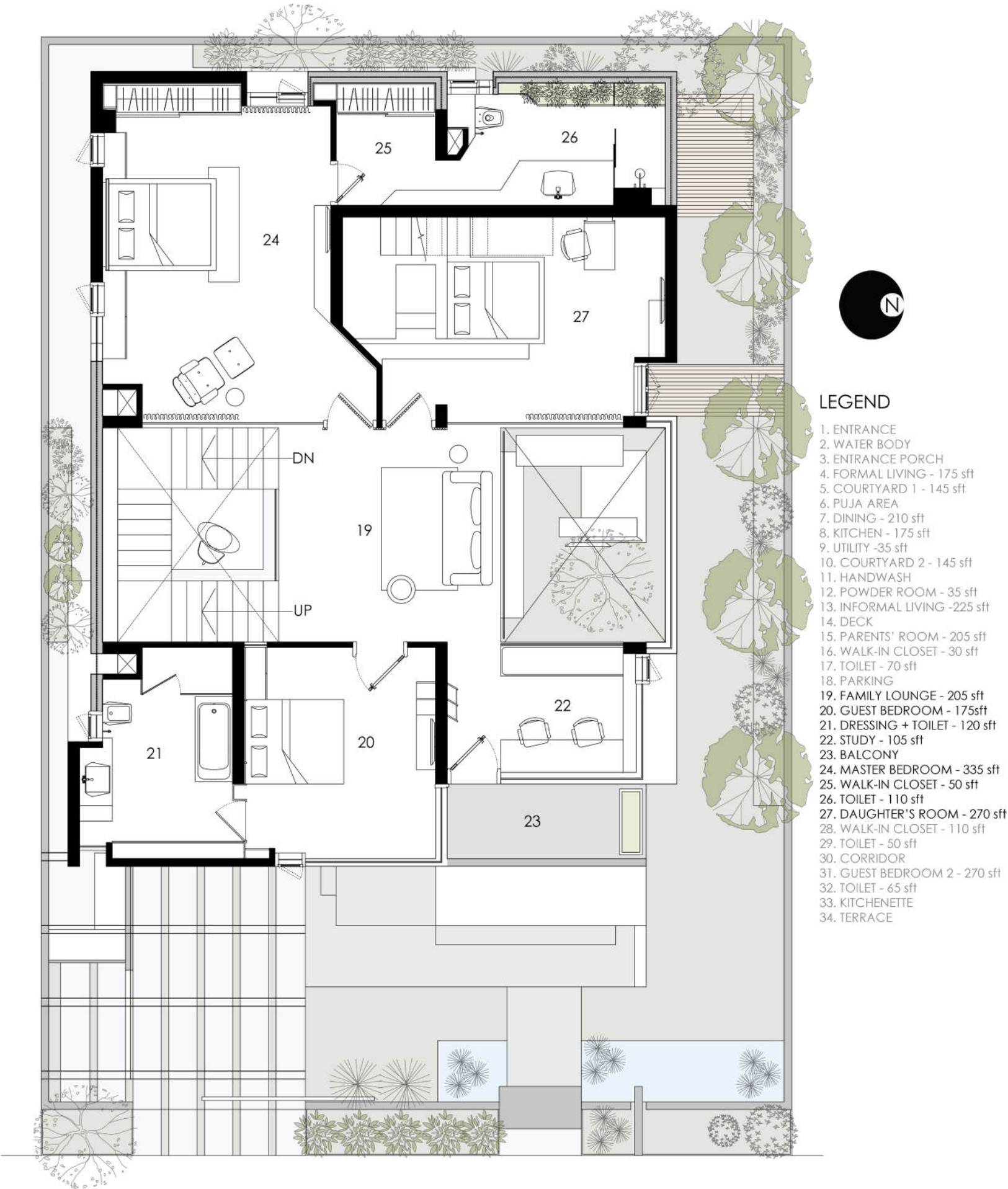
Spatially luxurious master bedroom

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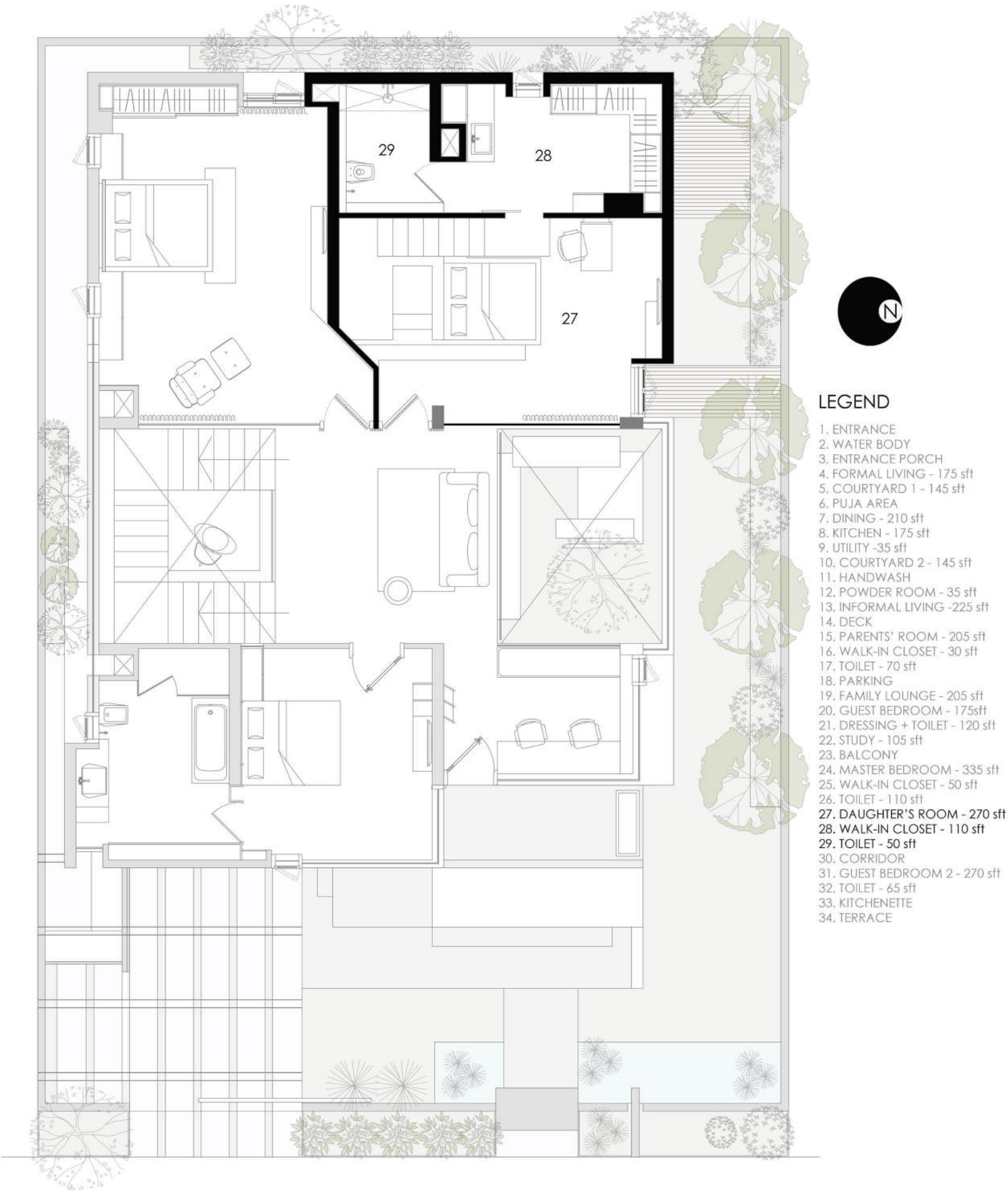


Master bathroom with trendy and modern design





First Floor Plan

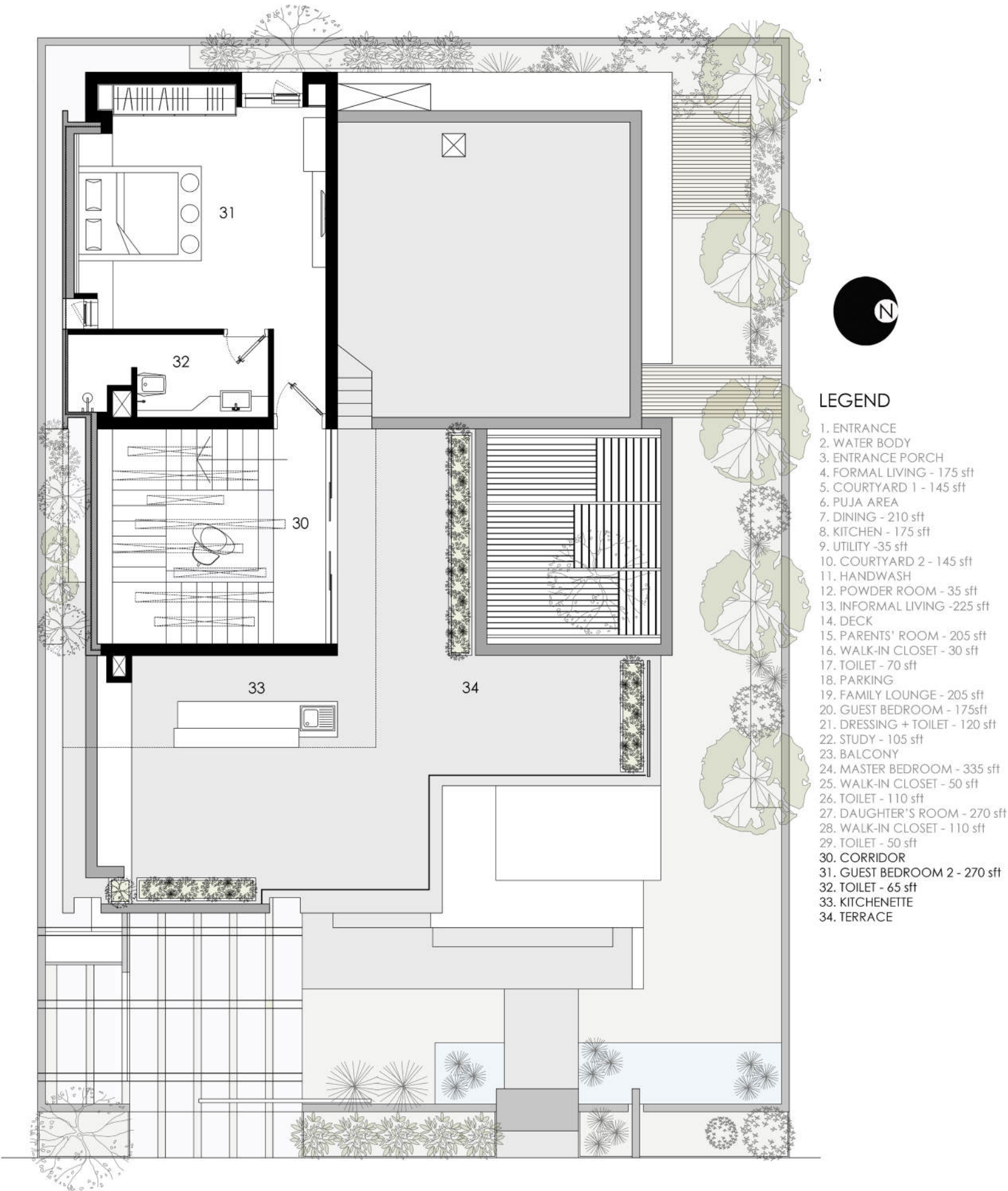


Mezzanine Floor Plan

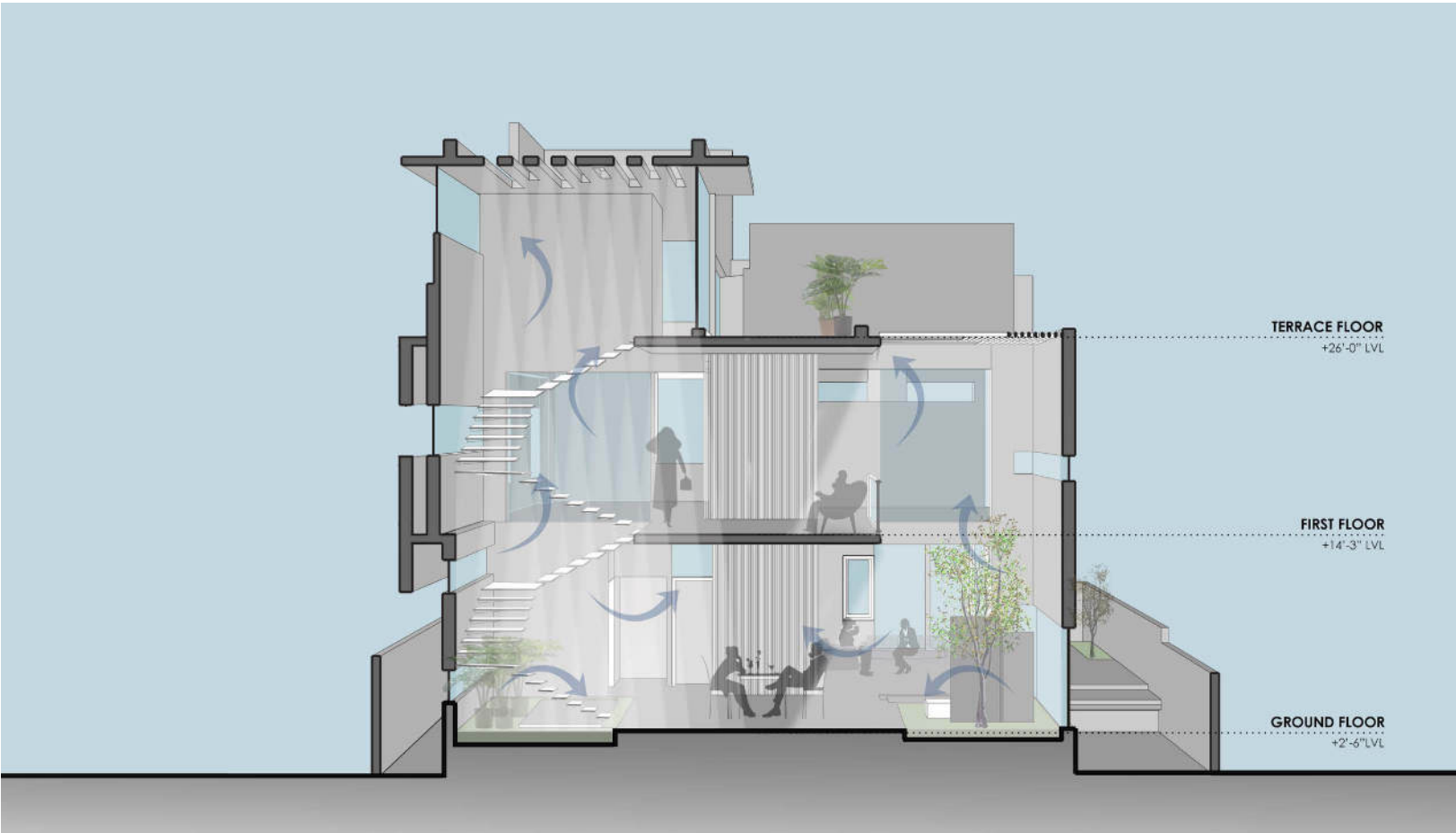


Pop of colors in guest bedroom

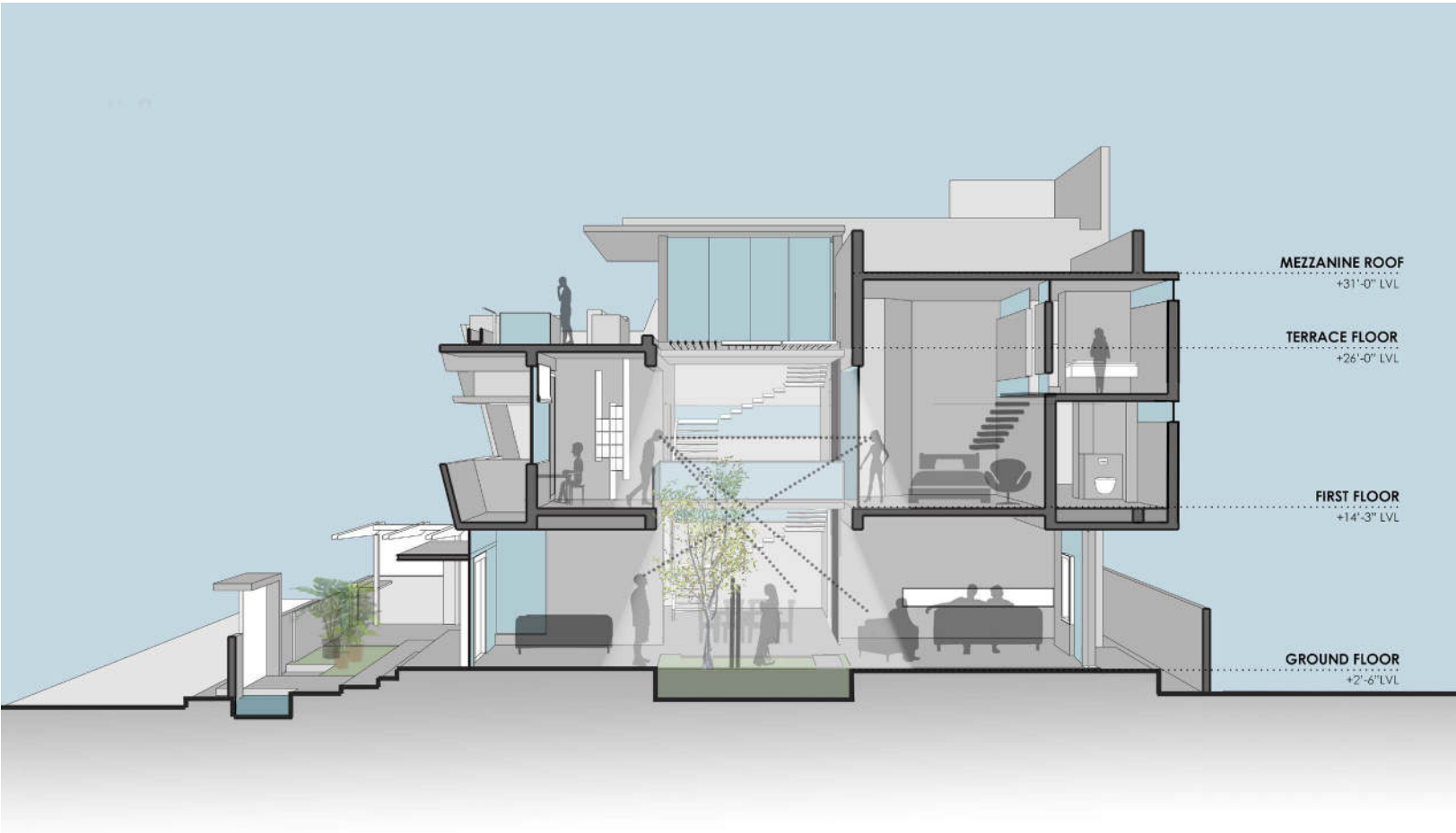




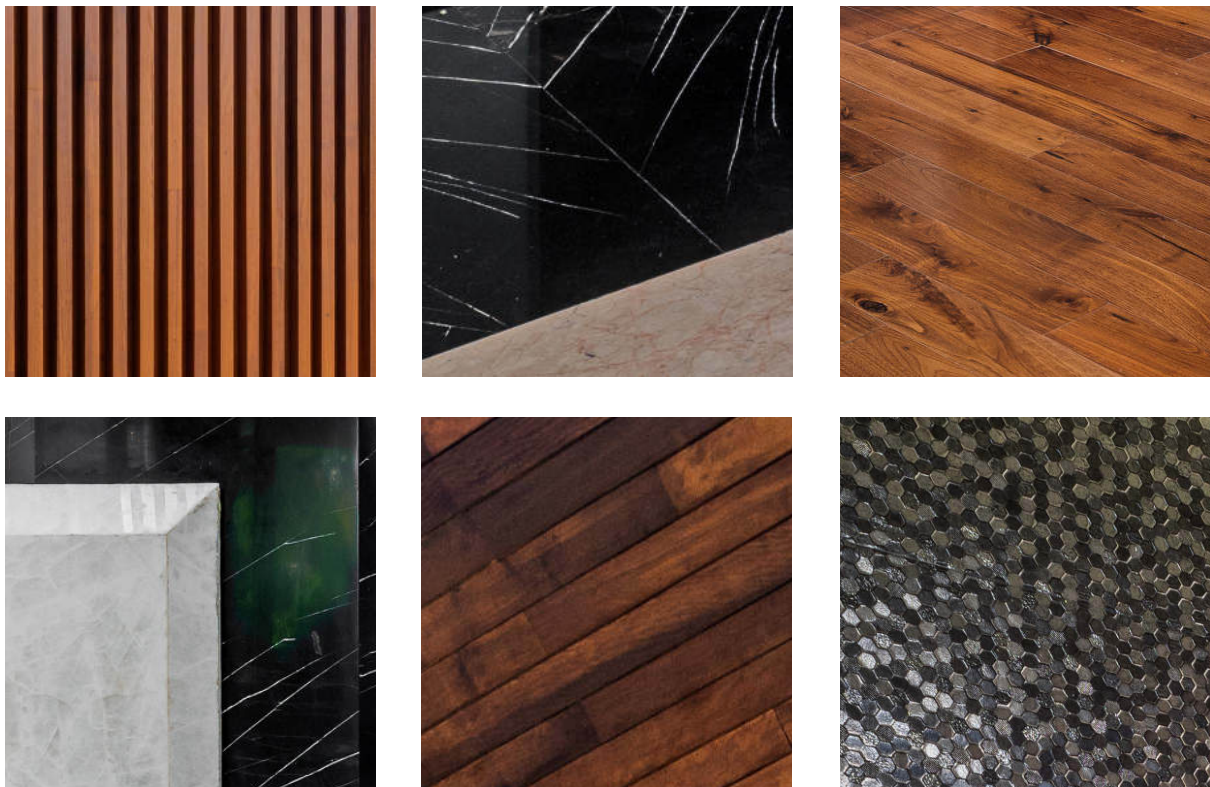
Second Floor Plan



Section 1



Section 2



UNIQUE MATERIAL APPLICATIONS

- Cladding: IPE Wood
- Windows: Burma teak
- Tiles: Keramos Tile & Stone, Johnson Tiles
- Lighting: Lightwell, Hybec
- Color: Asian Paints, MRF Vapocure Paints
- Sanitaryware: Toto, Kohler
- Bath Fittings: Hansgrohe
- Furniture: Natuzzi, Global Concepts, Script
- Furnishing: D'Décor, Kosh
- Carpets & Rugs: Global Concepts, Script
- Hardware: Hafele, Blum
- Modular Kitchen: Wurfel

- Ply/Veneer: Timex, Greenply
- Wooden Flooring: Trysqaure Flooring Pvt Ltd
- Security: Vigil Security Systems Pvt Ltd
- Air Conditioning: LG HVAC, Mitsubishi Electric
- Marble: Krismar

KEY CONTRIBUTORS

- Structural: Shivalinge Gowda K
- Landscape/MEP/HVAC: Crest Architects

PHOTO CREDITS

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